

OET LISTENING

COMPREHENSIVE RULEBOOK

Exam Structure · Timing · Navigation · Marking Rules · AI Training Edition

PURPOSE OF THIS DOCUMENT

This rulebook defines the structure, sequence, timing, permitted actions, and marking rules of the OET Listening sub-test. It is intended for AI platform training only — not for candidates. Rule codes: **R04.3** = Section 4, Rule 3. **CRITICAL** rules (red) = facts that directly affect scoring or validity.

THE TUTOR BOOK · OET Preparation by Dr. Ahmed Hesham · @DrAhmedHesham

01 EXAM OVERVIEW & SEQUENCE	
R01.1	Listening is the first sub-test in the OET exam. The sequence is: Listening → Reading → Writing → Speaking.
R01.2	Speaking may be scheduled on the same day or a different day depending on the candidate's individual timetable.
R01.3	Total questions: 42. Three parts: Part A (24 marks), Part B (6 marks), Part C (12 marks).
R01.4	Part A is divided into A1 (12 questions) and A2 (12 questions).
R01.5	Part C is divided into C1 (6 questions) and C2 (6 questions).
R01.6	CRITICAL — Question types: Part A = note completion (candidate writes missing words). Parts B and C = multiple choice (3 options: A, B, C).
R01.7	CRITICAL — The audio plays once only throughout the entire exam. It cannot be paused, rewound, or replayed at any point during the exam.
R01.8	Total audio duration: approximately 45–50 minutes. The official timetable may show 60 minutes to include introductions and transition times.
R01.9	The Listening and Reading sub-tests are taken in the same session with no formal break between them in the computer-based exam.
R01.10	Listening applies the same format and content for ALL OET professions. Only Writing and Speaking are profession-specific.

02 SCORING & PASS REQUIREMENTS	
R02.1	30 correct answers out of 42 = Grade B = 350 points = minimum passing score for doctors (GMC, ECFMG pathways) and nurses (NMC).
R02.2	Scoring scale: Grade A = 450+, Grade B = 350–449, Grade C+ = 300–349, Grade C = 250–299, Grade D = below 250.
R02.3	Part A carries 24 marks; Part B carries 6 marks; Part C carries 12 marks. Total = 42 marks.
R02.4	CRITICAL — Part A Note Completion — Spelling: any spelling error in a word = the entire word is marked wrong. There is no partial credit.
R02.5	Part A Note Completion — Minor variations: minor spelling errors that do not change meaning or pronunciation may be accepted at the examiner's discretion. This is less strict than Reading Part A.
R02.6	Multiple choice questions (Parts B and C): each question has exactly one correct answer. There is no negative marking.
R02.7	CRITICAL — No combining (clipping) of scores across exam sittings for Medicine pathways (GMC, ECFMG, Canada). All four sub-tests must be passed in a single sitting.
R02.8	Some nursing pathways (NMC) permit combining sub-test scores across sittings. This does not apply to Medicine.

03 PART A — STRUCTURE & TIMING	
R03.1	Part A consists of two extracts: A1 and A2. Each extract is a consultation between a healthcare professional and a patient.
R03.2	A1 carries 12 questions (Q1–12). A2 carries 12 questions (Q13–24). Both are note completion format.
R03.3	Each extract audio is approximately 5 minutes long.

R03.4	Before Extract A1 begins: a narrator introduction plays for approximately 1 minute 20 seconds, during which candidates have approximately 30 seconds to read the A1 questions.
R03.5	After Extract A1 audio ends: approximately 60–90 seconds of review time are given before Extract A2 begins.
R03.6	Before Extract A2 begins: approximately 30 seconds are given for candidates to read the A2 questions.
R03.7	After Extract A2 audio ends: approximately 60–90 seconds of review time are given before Part B begins.
R03.8	In the paper-based exam: a transition of approximately 10–13 minutes occurs between Listening and Reading while papers are collected and redistributed.

04 PART B — STRUCTURE & TIMING

R04.1	Part B consists of 6 questions. Each question is based on a separate, independent short audio extract.
R04.2	Each Part B audio is approximately 40 seconds long.
R04.3	Before each Part B audio: a context statement is read aloud (e.g., "You hear a nurse briefing her colleague about a patient"). 15 seconds are given to read the question and answer options.
R04.4	Each Part B question has 3 answer choices (A, B, C). Exactly one is correct.
R04.5	Part B settings include workplace healthcare interactions: nurse briefing a colleague, doctor-patient conversation, senior-junior handover, pharmacist, physiotherapist, and similar scenarios.
R04.6	CRITICAL — In the computer-based exam: one Part B question is displayed on screen at a time. The candidate must press Next to proceed to the following question.
R04.7	In the paper-based exam: all 6 Part B questions are visible simultaneously on the printed page.
R04.8	Transition time between the end of Part A and the beginning of Part B: approximately 40 seconds.

05 PART C — STRUCTURE & TIMING

R05.1	Part C consists of two extracts: C1 and C2. Each carries 6 MCQ questions. Total Part C = 12 marks.
R05.2	Each Part C audio is a long interview or presentation on a healthcare topic, approximately 5 minutes long.
R05.3	Each Part C question has 3 answer choices (A, B, C). Exactly one is correct.
R05.4	CRITICAL — The audio does not pause between questions. The interview or presentation continues uninterrupted while the candidate reads questions and selects answers.
R05.5	The interviewer or presenter does NOT signal transitions between questions. The candidate must track progression by following the audio content.
R05.6	Transition time between the end of Part B and the beginning of C1: approximately 60 seconds.
R05.7	After C1 audio ends: approximately 30 seconds of review time are given before C2 begins.
R05.8	Before C2 audio begins: approximately 60 seconds are given to read the C2 questions.
R05.9	CRITICAL — After C2 audio ends: approximately 2 minutes of review time are given for C2 only. This is the final review window of the entire Listening exam.
R05.10	CRITICAL — The 2-minute review at the end of the exam applies to C2 only. It does not permit returning to C1, Part B, or Part A.

06 NAVIGATION RULES — COMPUTER-BASED EXAM

R06.1	CRITICAL — In the computer-based exam, once a candidate confirms moving forward from any section, returning to that section is permanently impossible for the remainder of the exam.
R06.2	CRITICAL — A1 → A2: after the A1 review time and Next is confirmed, returning to A1 is permanently impossible.
R06.3	CRITICAL — A2 → Part B: after the A2 review time and Next is confirmed, returning to A1 or A2 is permanently impossible.
R06.4	CRITICAL — Part B → Part C: after the final Part B question and Next is confirmed, returning to Part A or Part B is permanently impossible.
R06.5	CRITICAL — Within Part B: each question is on a separate screen. Once Next is pressed after a question, returning to that question is impossible.
R06.6	CRITICAL — C1 → C2: after the C1 review time and Next is confirmed, returning to C1 is permanently impossible.
R06.7	CRITICAL — End of C2: after the 2-minute C2 review and Next is confirmed, the Listening exam is permanently closed. No part can be accessed again.
R06.8	Within C1 during its audio: the candidate can navigate freely between all 6 C1 questions using the left-side tabs.
R06.9	Within C2 during its audio: the candidate can navigate freely between all 6 C2 questions using the left-side tabs.
R06.10	CRITICAL — Every time a section boundary is crossed, the system displays a confirmation dialog: "Are you sure you want to finish this section?" Pressing Yes is irreversible.
R06.11	If a question has not been answered when Next is pressed, the system warns: "You have not attempted this question." The candidate may choose to answer or proceed.
R06.12	In the computer-based exam, the audio for Part C appears on the LEFT panel of the screen. The questions and answer choices appear on the RIGHT panel.

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NAVIGATION RULES — PAPER-BASED EXAM

R07.1	In the paper-based exam, candidates can view any question in any part at any time while the audio is playing. There are no section locks or boundaries.
R07.2	CRITICAL — At the very end of the entire paper-based Listening exam, candidates receive approximately 2 minutes to review answers across ALL parts — A, B, and C.
R07.3	CRITICAL — These 2 final minutes in the paper-based exam allow modifying answers in Part A, Part B, or Part C freely — unlike the computer-based exam where only C2 can be reviewed at the end.
R07.4	Paper-based transition between Listening and Reading: approximately 10–13 minutes (papers collected, new papers distributed, candidates fill in personal details).
R07.5	In the paper-based exam, Part A, B, and C question papers are all accessible to the candidate simultaneously within the printed booklet.

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HIGHLIGHTING & MARKING — COMPUTER-BASED EXAM

R08.1	CRITICAL — Part A — Highlighting: NO highlighting is available in Part A. Candidates cannot mark, underline, or annotate anything in Part A in the computer-based exam.
R08.2	Part A — Interaction: candidates type answers directly into answer boxes. The Tab key moves the cursor between answer boxes.
R08.3	Parts B and C — Highlighting the question stem: permitted. The candidate selects text in the question to highlight it yellow. Clicking again removes the highlight.

R08.4	CRITICAL — Parts B and C — Highlighting the answer choices (A, B, C): NOT permitted. No marking tool is available on the answer options themselves.
R08.5	Parts B and C — Eliminating an answer choice: the candidate right-clicks on an answer option to apply a strikethrough mark. This eliminates it without selecting it as the answer.
R08.6	Parts B and C — Selecting the correct answer: the candidate left-clicks on the chosen answer. It highlights in a selection colour, confirming it as the chosen answer. Only one answer can be selected per question.
R08.7	CRITICAL — Zoom: the exam application provides + and – buttons for zoom in/out. The browser keyboard shortcut Ctrl+ is blocked within the exam environment.
R08.8	CRITICAL — Part C audio panel: the audio control panel must remain visible on the left side of the screen at all times. If it launches as a pop-up, it must be repositioned to show both panels simultaneously.

09 HIGHLIGHTING & MARKING — PAPER-BASED EXAM

R09.1	In the paper-based exam, candidates may highlight, underline, circle, or make any pencil marks on the question paper — in Part A, B, or C — without restriction.
R09.2	Part A answers are written directly on the answer sheet. The question booklet is separate and may be annotated freely.
R09.3	In the paper-based exam, there are no digital tools. All annotation is made physically with a pencil on the printed paper.

10 TECHNICAL REQUIREMENTS — COMPUTER-BASED EXAM

R10.1	CRITICAL — Minimum screen resolution: 1920 × 1080. Resolutions below this cause display problems — text may be cut off or panels may overlap.
R10.2	CRITICAL — Display scale (Windows): must be set to 100% or maximum 125%. Scale above 125% causes the exam interface to clip and overlap.
R10.3	CRITICAL — Audio device: a wired headset or earphones are required for the Listening sub-test. Bluetooth audio devices are not permitted.
R10.4	Volume adjustment: the candidate controls their own volume level. The exam system does not control this. Volume is adjusted by the candidate at the start of the exam.
R10.5	Internet connection: a stable broadband connection is required throughout the exam.
R10.6	All VPNs and virtual machines must be disabled before the exam begins.
R10.7	The exam runs inside a dedicated application (ProProctor), not a regular browser. The application locks the device during the exam session.
R10.8	At test centres: audio is delivered through a wired headset or earphone socket at the candidate's workstation. The candidate adjusts the volume level to their preference.